

VS Code Search Cheatsheet: Searching Across Multiple Files with Excluded Folders

1. Open Search Panel

- Ctrl + Shift + F
- Or click the magnifying glass on the left sidebar.

2. Search a String

Enter your target text in the "Search" field.
Supports plain text or regex (toggle the .* button).

3. Include Specific File Types

Use the "Files to include" box:

- All .puml files: `**/*.puml`
- JSON schema files: `**/*.schema.json`
- Only inside a subfolder: `schemas/name/**/*.puml`

4. Exclude Folders and Subpaths

Use the "Files to exclude" box:

- Exclude snapshots folders:
`_snapshots/**, _snapshots-wip/**`
- Exclude multiple subpaths:
`_snapshots/**, _snapshots-wip/**, temp/**, dist/**`
- Exclude "generated" folders anywhere:
`**/generated/**`

(Use forward slashes / even on Windows.)

5. Useful Glob Patterns

- `folder/**` — exclude entire folder
- `**/folder/**` — exclude that folder name anywhere
- `folder/*.puml` — only .puml files in that folder
- `folder/**/*.json` — JSON files recursively

6. Open Search Result Files for Editing

- Click a match line to open file at location
- Drag filename onto the tab bar
- Right-click → Open File
- Ctrl-click multiple files → press Enter to open all
- Right-click folder group → Open All

7. Advanced Options

- Match case: Aa icon
- Whole word: ab icon
- Regex: .* icon

8. Permanent Workspace Exclusions

Add to settings.json:

```
"search.exclude": {  
  "_snapshots/**": true,  
  "_snapshots-wip/**": true,  
  "node_modules/**": true
```

}

9. Ripgrep (Terminal Search)

Open terminal (Ctrl + `) and run:

```
rg "pattern" -g "*.puml" -g "!_snapshots/**" -g "!_snapshots-wip/**"
```

More examples:

- Only .puml files:

```
rg "pattern" -g "*.puml"
```

- Exclude multiple folders:

```
rg "pattern" -g "!folder1/**" -g "!folder2/**"
```

10. Common Glob Examples

- Include all PUBL: `**/*.puml`

- Exclude folder: `folder/**`

- Exclude multiple: `folder1/**, folder2/**`

- Include only schema JSON: `**/*.schema.json`

- Include only a root folder: `schemas/**`